```
class SecretAgent
  secretWord = "antiquing"

secretWord?
# false
```

The secretWord variable isn't defined outside the class body.

Class variables are scoped to the class body. The class body has a variable scope like a function (as you'll see later, when compiled to JavaScript the class declaration really *is* a function). They look a little bit like instance properties; be careful to notice the distinction.

Class variables vs. instance properties

Variables always use the `=` operator, whereas object properties use the `:` operator:

```
class SecretAgent
  secretWord = "antiquing"
  licensedToKill: yes
```

Class variable

Instance property

Methods can access class variables because they're *inside* the class declaration with them:

```
class SecretAgent
  secretWord = "antiquing"
  greet: (word) ->
    if word is secretWord
      "Hello, how are you?"

bob = new SecretAgent
bob.greet "antiquing"
# "Hello, how are you?"
```

Class variable.

This method can see the class variable because it's in the same scope.

You now have a place to keep the product variable inside the `Product` class. Unfortunately, that also also makes it invisible to your *Product.find* class method:

```
class Product
  products

Product.find = (query) ->
  (product for product in products when product.name is query)
```

Class variable is defined in current scope.

Class variable isn't visible outside.